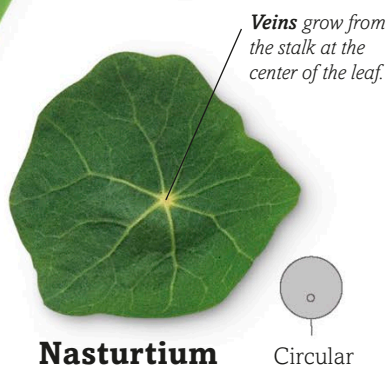
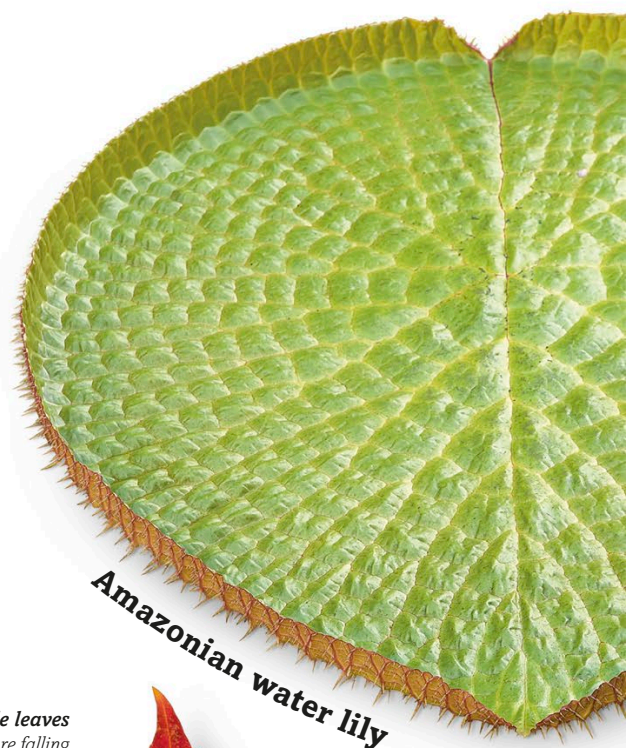
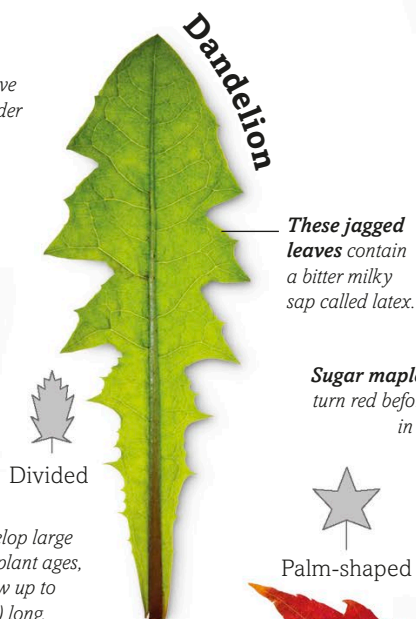
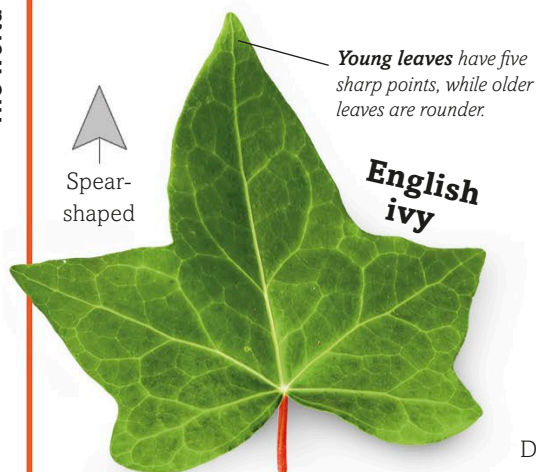




Simple leaves



A leaf typically consists of a flat surface called a **blade**, which carries a **network of veins**. These veins support the leaves and transport the water and minerals to them from the rest of the plant. A simple leaf has a single, undivided blade.

Simple leaves come in many shapes and sizes, and those best suited to their habitat are the most likely to thrive. In wet rain forest conditions plants have big leaves, while plants in drier locations usually have small leaves. Some plants, such as **English ivy** and **ginkgo**, change their leaf shape